

Braden Ransom

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EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine

Irvine, CA

B.S. Informatics – Human-Computer Interaction | GPA: 3.24 | 5x Dean's List

Expected May 2026

- Coursework: HCI, Advanced HCI, Software Engineering, Requirements Engineering, Health Informatics, Statistics

EXPERIENCE

NOW Pass

Dec. 2024 – Mar. 2025

UX Design Intern

Remote

- Shipped interaction flows, micro-animations, and UI components for an entertainment platform with **100,000+ active users**; collaborated with engineers on production handoff specs

Shades

Dec. 2024 – Mar. 2025

User Research Intern

Remote

- Led **100+ semi-structured interviews** and longitudinal diary studies on the Shades News mobile app; synthesized findings into prioritized design recommendations that shaped the product roadmap

Perplexity AI

Aug. 2025 – Dec. 2025

Campus Partner

Irvine, CA

- Ran monthly technical workshops on AI-assisted workflows; generated **\$15K in pipeline** for Comet browser launch through campus outreach and social campaigns

The Outspoken

Aug. 2020 – Aug. 2022

Director of Technical Writing

Pasadena, CA

- Led team of 5 journalists; published technical coverage of nuclear energy, mRNA vaccines, and space exploration — **30,000+ readers**

PROJECTS

BAA/RFP Proposal Automation | *Next.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, RAG, Claude API* Sep. 2025 – Mar. 2026

- Capstone with **Leidos & DARPA I2O** – full-stack document intelligence system; OCR-to-structured-output pipeline for requirement extraction with **RAG at ~73% confidence**
- Implemented RBAC via PostgreSQL row-level security; delivered end-to-end prototype to Leidos and DARPA I2O program managers

StepLadder | *Next.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Supabase, Recharts, Docker*

Aug. 2025 – Dec. 2025

- Designed and built a therapist-patient clinical workflow platform for CBT, DBT, ERP, and ACT interventions – **in beta with real clinicians**; replaced unstructured PDFs with guided task flows via iterative usability testing
- Shipped clinician dashboards with SUDS tracking, adherence analytics, and role-based access (therapist/patient/admin)

VagalTone | *Next.js 14, TypeScript, Zustand, Web Audio API, Framer Motion*

Jan. 2026 – Apr. 2026

- Protocol-locked paced-breathing intervention with **Web Audio API** cueing (oscillator scheduling, gain envelopes, 60 Hz visual sync); pre/post Likert psychometrics and local-first data schema for human-subjects research

Aulie | *Next.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Zod, Tailwind CSS*

Sep. 2024 – Jun. 2025

- Mobile-first full-stack app (voice + text) for capturing intrusive thoughts; heuristic NLP pipeline for cognitive pattern detection; Zod-validated REST APIs with multi-turn PostgreSQL state

Lua | *Figma, React, User Research*

Sep. 2024 – Jun. 2025

- Conducted **20 user interviews**; synthesized findings via affinity mapping into design principles; built high-fidelity Figma + React prototype with gamified CBT engagement loops

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, HTML/CSS

Frameworks: React, Next.js, React Native, Tailwind CSS, Framer Motion, Docker

Data & Backend: PostgreSQL, Supabase, Firebase, REST APIs, Zod, Web Audio API

AI / Systems: RAG pipelines, LLM integration (Claude API), heuristic NLP, OCR/PDF parsing

Design & Research: Figma, usability testing, semi-structured interviews, diary studies, affinity mapping, high-fidelity prototyping